

COVER ARTWORK • PLACEHOLDER

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# The future *is now*

IACTS TechnoCollege CME 2026 — a pre-conference workshop  
and a two-day CME built for the next generation of cardiothoracic  
surgeons.

DATES

**23 — 25 October 2026**

CITY

**Hyderabad, India**

CONVENED BY

**Department of CTVS, NIMS  
Hyderabad**

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LEARN IT • DO IT • CHALLENGE IT • INNOVATE IT

## MESSAGES FROM THE ORGANISING OFFICE-BEARERS

# The future is no longer something we are *waiting for*



ORGANISING CHAIRMAN

**Dr. G. Ravindra**

DEAR COLLEAGUES,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you all to IACTS Technocollege CME 2026, being conducted under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular and Thoracic Surgeons.

Technocollege is a timely initiative that brings together young surgeons, postgraduate trainees, experienced practitioners, innovators and technology leaders on a common platform. It is not simply a programme to learn new techniques; it is an opportunity to develop a mindset of adaptability, innovation and lifelong learning. The interactions, demonstrations and exchange of experiences during these three days will, I hope, inspire participants to look beyond the operating room of today and envision the possibilities of tomorrow.

Hyderabad provides a wonderful setting for this meeting. A city that seamlessly combines a rich cultural heritage with a rapidly growing ecosystem of medicine, technology, innovation and entrepreneurship, Hyderabad truly reflects the spirit of this conference. I warmly invite all delegates to experience not only the scientific programme, but also the legendary hospitality, culture, cuisine and warmth of Hyderabad.

I am confident that Technocollege 2026 will be an enriching experience—academically stimulating, professionally inspiring and personally memorable.

I look forward to welcoming each one of you to Hyderabad and to this exciting journey into the future of cardiothoracic surgery.

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Dr. G. Ravindra · Organising Chairman

ORGANISING SECRETARY

**Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati**

DEAR COLLEAGUES,

Cardiovascular and thoracic surgery is witnessing an unprecedented transformation. Technologies that were once considered futuristic—minimally invasive and robotic surgery, advanced aortic interventions, mechanical circulatory support, organ transplantation, image-guided procedures and sophisticated thoracic techniques—are rapidly becoming part of contemporary surgical practice. The future is no longer something we are waiting for; it is already happening in our operating rooms.

It is with this conviction that we present IACTS Technocollege CME 2026, under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular and Thoracic Surgeons (IACTS). Conceived primarily for postgraduate students and young surgeons in the early stages of their careers, Technocollege is designed to bridge the gap between conventional surgical training and the rapidly evolving technological landscape of our specialty.

We believe that young surgeons should not have to wait until they are established in their careers to encounter the technologies that are transforming our specialty. Technocollege is therefore conceived as a platform to expose, train, question, interact and innovate. More importantly, it brings together young surgeons and pioneers of the field, creating an environment where experiences can be shared, ideas challenged and the learning curve shortened.

Technocollege 2026 is not merely about predicting what cardiac and thoracic surgery will look like tomorrow. It is about experiencing the technology that is already shaping it today.

The future is now. And we invite you to be a part of it.

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Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati · Organising Secretary

## ABOUT THE CME

# Built for the surgeons who will practise the next decade.

## CONCEIVED FOR

Postgraduate students and young surgeons early in their careers.

## A PLATFORM TO

Expose

Train

Question

Interact

Innovate

Conceived primarily for postgraduate students and young surgeons in the early stages of their careers, Technocollege is designed to bridge the gap between conventional surgical training and the rapidly evolving technological landscape of our specialty.

Young surgeons should not have to wait until they are established in their careers to encounter the technologies that are transforming our specialty. Technocollege brings together young surgeons and pioneers of the field, creating an environment where experiences can be shared, ideas challenged and the learning curve shortened.

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## FOUR SCIENTIFIC DOMAINS

01 Minimally Invasive and Robotic Cardiac Surgery

02 Aortic Surgery

03 Heart-Lung Transplantation

04 Complex Congenital and Thoracic Surgery

INCLUDING VATS AND ROBOTIC THORACIC SURGERY

## DAY 0

## Pre-Conference Workshop

Surgical skills & innovation — aortic and coronary labs, Technology Olympics, innovation forum and young surgeons' papers.

## SIGNATURE FORMATS

01 "How I Do It" technical presentations

02 Hands-on surgical laboratories & tech demos

## DAY 1

## MIS, Robotic & Aortic Surgery

The new operating room — MICS, robotics, contemporary aortic surgery, pediatric and the digital surgeon.

03 Technology Olympics — competitive skills

04 Case battles & expert panels

05 Young Innovators' pitch & paper sessions

## DAY 2

## Transplant, Thoracic & Innovation

Heart/lung transplant and MCS, VATS and robotic thoracic, surgeon-led MedTech, research and the future of CVTS.

06 AI, digital twins & simulation

07 Entrepreneurship & personal finance

08 Industry technology labs

OPERATE WELL • THINK CRITICALLY • INNOVATE RESPONSIBLY

DAY 0 • 23 OCTOBER 2026 • 8:30 AM — 6:00 PM • NIMS • NIZAM'S INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, PUNJAGUTTA

# Surgical Skills & Innovation

A highly interactive, capacity-limited pre-conference workshop for postgraduate trainees, fellows and young surgeons — five core components run in parallel stations.

## 01 Aortic Surgery Laboratory

Hands-on training in contemporary aortic surgical techniques and technologies.

## 02 Coronary Anastomosis Laboratory

Focused training in the principles and practice of coronary anastomosis.

## 03 Technology Olympics

A competitive surgical skills challenge across coronary, aortic, robotic and MIS skills.

## 04 Innovation Display & Young Innovators' Forum

A platform to present innovative ideas, devices, techniques and technology solutions.

## 05 Young Surgeons' Paper Presentation

A competitive scientific session showcasing high-quality trainee research.

LEARN IT • DO IT • CHALLENGE IT

Every station is built around doing — not watching. Workshop places are limited and allocated with registration — select your preference in the registration form.

INDUSTRY × SURGEON • TECHNOLOGY LABS

Built around hands-on education rather than sponsored lectures — six immersive labs run alongside the scientific programme.

## 01 Robotic Surgery Lab

Console • camera control • instrument manipulation • needle driving • suturing • knot tying • emergency undocking

## 02 Aortic Technology Lab

Frozen Elephant Trunk • TEVAR • hybrid arch • proximal anastomotic devices • aortic grafts • cerebral protection

## 03 Coronary Anastomosis Lab

Anastomotic devices • surgical instruments • sutures • beating-heart simulation • microsurgical techniques

## 04 Thoracic Stapling Lab

Vascular • bronchial • parenchymal and difficult-angle stapling • staple-line reinforcement • troubleshooting

## 05 ECMO & MCS Lab

ECMO cannulation • circuit configuration • troubleshooting • LVAD technology • emergency MCS scenarios

## 06 Digital Surgery Lab

3-D surgical planning • VR simulation • digital twins • AI-assisted imaging • surgical video analytics

# Minimally Invasive, Robotic & Aortic

|           | Inauguration & Keynote                                                                                                                                                   | 8:15 — 10:45 AM    |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 8:15      | REGISTRATION & BREAKFAST                                                                                                                                                 |                    |
| 9:00      | Inauguration · The Future-Ready Cardiothoracic Surgeon<br>Welcome address & introduction to IACTS TechnoCollege                                                          |                    |
| 9:45      | <b>Keynote — Scientific Fervour: From Curiosity to Discovery &amp; Innovation</b> <small>TENTATIVE</small><br>Prof. V. Ramgopal Rao · Group Vice-Chancellor, BITS Pilani |                    |
| 10:30     | <b>Keynote Discussion</b>                                                                                                                                                |                    |
| 10:45     | TEA BREAK                                                                                                                                                                |                    |
| <b>S1</b> | <b>Minimally Invasive &amp; Robotic Cardiac Surgery</b>                                                                                                                  | 11:00 AM — 1:00 PM |
| 11:00     | MICS in 2026: Where Should a Young Surgeon Start?<br>Dr. Nitin Rajput                                                                                                    |                    |
| 11:15     | Mini-MVR: Patient Selection, Port Placement & Exposure<br>Dr. Nitin Rajput                                                                                               |                    |
| 11:30     | Mini-AVR: How I Do It<br>Dr. Nagesh                                                                                                                                      |                    |
| 11:45     | Robotic Mitral Surgery: From Simulation to Independent Surgery<br>Dr. Vishal Khante                                                                                      |                    |
| 12:00     | Robotic CABG: What Does the Evidence Really Show?<br>Dr. Gokhale                                                                                                         |                    |
| 12:15     | Endoscopic / Robotic Conduit Harvesting<br>Dr. Ritwick Bhuyan                                                                                                            |                    |
| 12:30     | Cannulation & Perfusion Strategies for MICS<br>Dr. Nagesh                                                                                                                |                    |
| 12:45     | <b>Panel — Is Robotic Cardiac Surgery Ready for Every Centre?</b><br>Expert Panel                                                                                        |                    |
| 1:00      | LUNCH                                                                                                                                                                    |                    |

|      | Contemporary Aortic Surgery                                                       | 1:45 — 3:45 PM |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 1:45 | Acute Type A Dissection: The First 30 Minutes<br>Dr. Praveen Varma                |                |
| 2:00 | Aortic Root: Valve-Sparing vs Bentall — How I Decide<br>Dr. Idhrees               |                |
| 2:15 | Arch Replacement: Cerebral Protection Strategies<br>Dr. Idhrees                   |                |
| 2:30 | Frozen Elephant Trunk: Who Needs It and How I Do It<br>Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati  |                |
| 2:45 | Hybrid Arch & TEVAR: Where Does the Surgeon Fit?<br>Dr. Kaladhar                  |                |
| 3:00 | Proximal Anastomotic Devices: Do We Really Need Them?<br>Dr. Praveen Varma        |                |
| 3:15 | Choosing the Right Graft<br>Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati                             |                |
| 3:30 | <b>Aortic Case Battle — Two Surgeons, One Difficult Arch Case</b><br>Expert Panel |                |

Case battle decision points — operative strategy · cannulation · cerebral protection · extent of arch replacement · FET vs conventional · hybrid options · management of complications.

|      | Pediatric & The Digital Surgeon                                                                            | 4:00 — 5:30 PM |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 4:00 | Pediatric Valve Repairs: Principles and Pitfalls<br>Dr. Rajasekhar                                         |                |
| 4:15 | Changing Face of Redo Surgery in the Pediatric Population<br>Dr. Rajasekhar                                |                |
| 4:30 | AI in Cardiac Surgery: From ChatGPT to the Operating Room<br>Dr. Amaresh Rao                               |                |
| 4:45 | AI for Postoperative Follow-up Care: AID-PaMS<br>Mr. Khetan Bhokray                                        |                |
| 5:00 | Digital Twin, VR & Surgical Simulation: Where Are We Going?<br>University of Hyderabad                     |                |
| 5:15 | <b>Interactive Panel — Will AI Replace the Surgeon, or the Surgeon Who Doesn't Use AI?</b><br>Expert Panel |                |

## The Young Surgeon's Toolkit

5:30 — 6:00 PM • THREE SHORT TALKS

### Personal Finance for Young Surgeons

Building financial independence from day one of a surgical career.

### Entrepreneurship for the Young Surgeon

From clinical problem to sustainable enterprise.

### Academic & Professional Identity

Research, networking, teaching and responsible social media.

# Transplant, Thoracic & Innovation

## S4 Heart, Lung & Heart–Lung Transplantation 9:00 — 11:00 AM

|       |                                                                                         |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 9:00  | Heart Transplantation in India: Where Are We Today?<br>Dr. Kaladhar                     |
| 9:15  | Recipient Selection: Who Should Get a Transplant?<br>Dr. Bala Subramanyam               |
| 9:30  | Donor Management & Organ Procurement: The Critical Steps<br>Dr. Bala Subramanyam        |
| 9:45  | Lung Transplantation: What a Cardiac Surgeon Should Know<br>Dr. Attawar                 |
| 10:00 | Heart–Lung Transplantation: When and How?<br>Dr. Attawar                                |
| 10:15 | LVAD: Bridge, Destination or Bridge-to-Decision?<br>Dr. Gokhale                         |
| 10:30 | ECMO as Bridge to Transplant / Recovery<br>Dr. Gokhale                                  |
| 10:45 | <b>Panel — Optimal Management in CAD &amp; Congestive Heart Failure</b><br>Expert Panel |
| 11:00 | TEA BREAK                                                                               |

## S5 VATS, Robotic & Minimally Invasive Thoracic Surgery 11:15 AM — 1:15 PM

|       |                                                                                   |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11:15 | VATS in 2026: What Every Young Thoracic Surgeon Must Know<br>Dr. P. S. S. Gopal   |
| 11:30 | Robotic Lobectomy: How I Do It<br>Dr. Aravind                                     |
| 11:45 | Robotic Thoracic Surgery: Is It Worth the Investment?<br>Dr. Bala Subramanyam     |
| 12:00 | Uniportal VATS: Getting Started<br>Dr. Manjunath Bale                             |
| 12:15 | Complex Segmentectomy: Beyond the Basics<br>Dr. Bala Subramanyam                  |
| 12:30 | Mediastinal Surgery Through Minimal Access<br>Dr. P. S. S. Gopal                  |
| 12:45 | VATS Thymectomy: Tips for the Young Surgeon<br>Dr. Manjunath Bale                 |
| 1:00  | <b>Panel — Making Sense of Newer Hardware in Thoracic Surgery</b><br>Expert Panel |
| 1:15  | LUNCH & INNOVATION DISPLAY                                                        |

## S6 From Surgical Problem to MedTech Innovation 2:00 — 3:30 PM

|      |                                                                                             |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2:00 | From Surgical Problem to Device: Where Do I Start?                                          |
| 2:10 | Design Thinking for Surgeons                                                                |
| 2:20 | Patent vs Publication: What Should I Do First?                                              |
| 2:30 | Prototype to Product: The MedTech Journey                                                   |
| 2:40 | Regulatory Approval in India: What a Surgeon Needs to Know                                  |
| 2:50 | Working with Engineers: How Not to Kill Your Idea                                           |
| 3:00 | <b>Young Innovators' Pitch Session</b><br>Problem → Idea → Prototype → Impact → What's Next |

## S7 Research That Changes Practice 3:45 — 4:45 PM

|      |                                                                                                                                          |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3:45 | Clinical Problem to Research Question — and Publishing Your First Good Paper<br>A practical master class for trainees and young surgeons |
| 4:15 | Big Data, Registries & Real-World Evidence in CVTS<br>Registries, AI-enabled datasets and multicentre collaboration                      |

S8 • 4:45 – 5:30 PM

# CVTS 2035 — The Future Operating Room

*What will the young surgeon actually need to learn?*

## ON THE TABLE

- Robotics
- Artificial intelligence
- AR & VR
- Surgical simulation
- Digital twins
- Image-guided surgery
- 3-D printing
- Transcatheter-surgical convergence
- Remote & telesurgery
- Personalised surgery
- Tissue engineering
- Implantable sensors
- Autonomous surgical assistance

## PROPOSED PANEL

- Cardiac Surgeon
- Thoracic Surgeon
- Transplant Surgeon
- Robotic Surgeon
- AI / Data Scientist
- Biomedical Engineer
- Industry Representative
- Young CVTS Surgeon

## CLOSING CEREMONY • THE NEXT-GENERATION CARDIOTHORACIC SURGEON

Operate well. Think critically. Research relentlessly. Innovate responsibly. Embrace technology without losing the art of surgery.

## SCIENTIFIC HIGHLIGHTS

### 01 Hands-On

SURGICAL WORKSHOPS & LIVE DEMONSTRATIONS

Cadaveric & simulation based workshops · Live surgical demonstrations by experts · Real-time guidance and feedback

### 02 Next-Gen Technology

PLENARY SESSIONS & DIDACTIC LECTURES

Cutting-edge innovations in cardiothoracic surgery · Evidence-based updates from global experts · Emerging technologies shaping the future

### 03 Scientific Exchange

INTERACTIVE SCIENTIFIC PANELS

Debates & discussions on current controversies · Multidisciplinary knowledge sharing · Case-based learning sessions

### 04 Collaboration

NETWORKING DINNER & SCIENTIFIC INTERACTION

Connect, collaborate & build the future together · Networking with national & international faculty · Strengthening professional partnerships

### 05 Young Surgeons' Forum

A PLATFORM FOR EMERGING TALENT

Platform for young talent to present & interact · Encouraging research & new ideas · Mentorship & career guidance

### 06 Best Paper & E-Poster Awards

RECOGNITION OF EXCELLENCE

Recognition of excellence in research · Encouraging innovation & academic growth · Rewarding impactful contributions

### 07 Patient Centric Care

QUALITY OUTCOMES & PATIENT SAFETY

Focus on quality outcomes & patient safety · Translating science into better patient care · Patient-first approach in every decision

### 08 Global Perspective

INTERNATIONAL FACULTY & COLLABORATIONS

International faculty & global collaborations · Insights into the future of cardiothoracic surgery · Benchmarking best practices worldwide

LEARN FROM EXPERTS

EXPERIENCE  
INNOVATION

ADVANCE YOUR  
PRACTICE

NETWORK &  
COLLABORATE

SHAPE THE FUTURE

## REGISTRATION

# Fees & how to *register*

Charged at the tier active on the date payment is received. All amounts in Indian rupees, inclusive of GST.

| CATEGORY           | EARLY BIRD                 | STANDARD                   | SPOT REGISTRATION         |
|--------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|
|                    | 01 JAN 2026 – 27 SEPT 2026 | 28 SEPT 2026 – 11 OCT 2026 | 12 OCT 2026 – 25 OCT 2026 |
| Resident / Trainee | ₹3,000                     | ₹5,000                     | ₹7,000                    |
| IACS Member        | ₹5,000                     | ₹7,000                     | ₹10,000                   |
| Non-Member         | ₹7,000                     | ₹9,000                     | ₹12,000                   |

## INCLUDED WITH EARLY BIRD

## Complimentary twin-sharing accommodation at the venue

Early Bird rates apply until 27 Sept 2026. Concessional categories require proof of eligibility.

## PAY TO THIS ACCOUNT

## ACCOUNT NAME

Indian Association of  
Cardiovascular-Thoracic Surgeons

## ACCOUNT NUMBER

1026896747

## BANK • IFSC

Central Bank of India  
CBIN0280601

Mumbai Central Branch, Mumbai  
400008



SCAN TO PAY BY UPI

## 01 Register online

Complete the delegate form on the conference website.

## 02 Pay the fee

Transfer by NEFT, IMPS or UPI using the account details or the QR code.

## 03 Attach your proof

Enter the UTR / transaction reference and upload the payment screenshot. Both are required.

## 04 Receive confirmation

The secretariat matches your payment and issues your registration ID and QR pass by email.

## YOU WILL BE ASKED FOR

Name, email and mobile • designation and specialization • institution • medical registration number • registration category • workshop preference • accommodation requirement • UTR and payment screenshot.

## REGISTRATION HELPLINE

**Virinchi • +91 9014772432**

REGISTER NOW

FULL FEE DETAILS

[iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/register](https://iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/register)



## ABSTRACTS

# Abstract *submission*

## LAST DATE

**11 October  
2026**

## FORMAT

Decided by the scientific committee after review — paper or poster. You do not choose.

**SUBMIT**

[iactstechnocollegecme2](https://iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/abstracts)

[026.com/abstracts](https://iactstechnocollegecme2026.com/abstracts)

[contact@iactstechnocol](mailto:contact@iactstechnocollegecme2026.com)

[legecme2026.com](mailto:contact@iactstechnocollegecme2026.com)

Abstracts and case reports are invited for the scientific programme. Conference registration is mandatory before you submit, and submission is online only through the conference website.

**01** Conference registration is mandatory for abstract submission.

**02** The first name in each abstract should be that of the presenting author.

**03** All abstracts/case reports must be submitted in English.

**04** Abstract in brief includes aim, materials and methods, results, conclusion & clinical significance.

**05** For case reports, introduction, case presentation, discussion & conclusion should be included.

**06** Abstract in comprehensible English typed in Microsoft Word, Calibri font, size 14, not more than 500 words.

**07** The abstracts should not have been presented or published in any other conference.

**08** Only the presenting author will be entitled to get a certificate.

**09** Abstracts/case reports submitted will be sent to the scientific committee for review and acceptance.

**10** Final date for submission is 11 October 2026.

## WHERE IT HAPPENS

## DAY 0 • 23 OCT

## NIMS Hyderabad

Nizam's Institute of Medical Sciences

Punjagutta, Hyderabad, Telangana 500082

Both venues are centrally located with easy access from Rajiv Gandhi International Airport and the city centre. Travel notes and recommended stays will be shared with registered delegates.

## EXPLORE HYDERABAD

### Golconda Fort

16TH CENTURY

Granite citadel of the Qutb Shahi kings, famous for acoustics that carry a handclap from the gateway to the summit.

### Salar Jung Museum

COLLECTION

One of the largest one-man collections in the world — sculpture, manuscripts and textiles from across continents.

### Hussain Sagar

HEART OF THE CITY

The lake dividing Hyderabad from Secunderabad, with the monolithic Buddha at its centre.

### Birla Mandir

NAUBATH PAHAD

White marble on the hill above Hussain Sagar, with one of the widest views over the city.

## DAY 1 &amp; 2 • 24–25 OCT

## Dr. MCR HRD Institute

Dr. MCR HRD Institute Auditorium

Road No. 25, Jubilee Hills, Hyderabad, Telangana 500033

### Ramoji Film City

DAY TRIP

The world's largest integrated film studio complex, on the eastern edge of the city.

### HITEC City

MODERN HYDERABAD

The technology and biotech corridor that made Hyderabad a centre for research and pharma.

## LEADERSHIP

Organising *committee*

## PATRONS

**Dr. Rahul Devraj**

CHIEF PATRON

**Dr. P. Chandrashekhar**

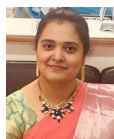
CO-PATRON

## ORGANISING COMMITTEE

**Dr. G. Ravindra**ORGANISING  
CHAIRMAN**Dr. Amaresh Rao Malempati**ORGANISING  
SECRETARY**Dr. Tella Rama Krishna Dev**ORGANISING  
CO-SECRETARY**Dr. Anita Bhalla**ORGANISING  
CO-SECRETARY**Dr. Abhijeet M Dashetwar**

TREASURER

## EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

**Dr. B. Kaladhar****Dr. P. S. S. Gopal****Dr. P. Sai Surabhi****Dr. D. Praveen****Dr. K. Sahir Vardhan Reddy****Dr. T. Uday****Dr. A. Bhargavi****Dr. S. Sireesha****Dr. J. Pramodh Reddy****Dr. Y. Harshita****Dr. M. Tribhuvan**

## CONFERENCE SECRETARIAT

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## REGISTRATION HELPLINE

**Virinchi  
+91 9014772432**

## WEBSITE

iactstechnocollegecme2026.com

## DATES &amp; CITY

**23 — 25 October 2026**

Hyderabad, India

Advancing care today, shaping the future of tomorrow.

**REGISTER****PROGRAMME**

## LEARN IT • DO IT • CHALLENGE IT • INNOVATE IT

Under the aegis of the Indian Association of Cardiovascular-Thoracic Surgeons • Convened by Department of CTVS, NIMS Hyderabad